



Enough spectrum available to start 5G services: Ravi Shankar Prasad

Telecom minister Ravi Shankar Prasad has said that the spectrum proposed for auction is enough to launch 5G services in the country. Industry body Broadband India Forum (BIF), however, has said that the quantum of frequency proposed is insufficient to start the next-gen mobile services.

The minister informed the Lok Sabha in a written reply that the 275MHz radio wave frequency, spectrum 3,300MHz to 3,400MHz and 3,425MHz to 3,600MHz bands, is available for 5G auction.

"BIF, in its representation to the government, has stated that the quan-

tum of 5G spectrum that has been allocated for the upcoming 5G spectrum auction is not enough for a country of India's size and density. In DoT's view, the present available spectrum is enough to start the 5G services," Prasad said.

According to ITU, a 5G application in general should be able to transmit data at a speed of ten gigabits per second and in some cases twenty gigabits per second. Industry experts have said the lower data speeds require around 320MHz of spectrum, while higher data speeds need around 670MHz.

Government planning national-level blockchain framework

According to Blockchain Report 2019 by NASSCOM, adoption of blockchain technology in India is experiencing rapid growth. To push this growth further, the Indian government is currently working on a strategy to scale up and widely deploy this new-age technology.

Sanjay Dhotre, minister of state for electronics and IT, in response to a question in Lok Sabha, said that the government is considering the potential usage of blockchain technology and the need for shared infrastructure for its different use-cases. For this, Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) is preparing

an approach paper on National Level Blockchain Framework.

The minister also said that for MeitY, blockchain is one of the important research areas as it finds the potential application of this new-age technology in such domains as governance, banking and finance, cybersecurity, among others.

MeitY has supported a multi-institutional project titled Distributed Centre of Excellence in Blockchain Technology with Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC), Institute for Development & Research in Banking Technology (IDRBT) and others as executing agencies.

Tamil Nadu government to set up Electronics Manufacturing Promotion Fund

Tamil Nadu government is planning to set up Electronics Manufacturing Promotion Fund with a limit of fifty million rupees annually. The fund

will be used to participate in and hold events to promote electronics manufacturing in consultation with the associations concerned, including

ON THE move

Sundar Pichai named CEO of Google's parent firm, Alphabet

Google chief executive officer (CEO) Sundar Pichai will assume the role of CEO at parent firm Alphabet in a shakeup at the tech giant. Pichai will take over from Larry Page, co-founder of the Internet giant, at the holding firm that includes Google as well as other units. Page and Google co-founder Sergey Brin will continue their involvement as co-founders, shareholders and members of Alphabet's board of directors. Alphabet was formed in 2015, giving a separate identity to the original company Google and other projects such as autonomous car unit Waymo and smart cities group Sidewalk Labs.

Shah joins Haptik as VP

Haptik, a subsidiary of Reliance Industries and one of the world's largest conversational artificial intelligence (AI) platforms, has announced that Saumil Shah has joined the company as vice president of engineering. Shah, who was recently at Box.com, will join the executive leadership team of Haptik to run end-to-end engineering and product delivery. He will report directly to co-founder and chief technical officer Swapn Rajdev, and be based in the company's headquarters in Mumbai.

Tata Communications appoints Lakshminarayanan as MD and CEO

Tata Communications has appointed Amur Swaminathan Lakshminarayanan as managing director (MD) and chief executive officer (CEO). The appointment came following resignation of Vinod Kumar from the post in July. Prior to joining Tata Communications, Lakshminarayanan was president and CEO of Tata Consultancy Services Japan, where he worked towards accelerating the company's market opportunities and developing the brand in the region.

Vishal Sikka joins Oracle's board of directors

Former Infosys chief executive officer Vishal Sikka, who recently launched his artificial intelligence (AI) startup Vianai Systems, has been nominated to the board of directors of global technology major Oracle.

Jony Ive bids goodbye to Apple

Jony Ive, Apple's chief design officer who is behind the look and feel of iPhone or iMac, has formally left Apple to form an independent design firm called LoveFrom, which would treat Apple as its most prestigious client. Ive worked at Apple for almost thirty years. He has been the key design figure behind such products as the original iMac, iPod, iPhone, iPad, Apple Watch and Apple's new spaceship campus.